



▲ **This illustration** from the Italian newspaper *L'illustrazione Italiana* of 4 April 1880 shows the opening of the Gotthard Tunnel.

Electric beginnings

Cities emerged, grew, and expanded, bringing with them the need for better connectivity. Metro services were almost inevitable. In 1900, the iconic Metro system in Paris opened its first section followed by the Subway in New York a few years later in 1904. Rapid advancement, however, did not mean the end of steam locomotives, yet. They still had plenty of life left in them and it would be a while before they would truly be replaced. Until then, work continued on making them efficient. Perhaps one of the key innovations during this time was in Britain when GWR's George Jackson Churchward developed the innovative 4-6-0 shaping the future of steam traction.

Yet the beginnings of the electric era were laid in the US when, in 1895, the Baltimore and Ohio Railroad began running an electrified route through its Howard Street Tunnel in response to issues with locomotive